Rahman al-Surayhi, who contributed to the construction of Lashkar's compound there.[31] Salafi religious scholars and other elders (and possibly the ISI) intervened to resolve the dispute, and the two sides soon reconciled.[32]

This was a temporary split, driven by personal animosity and internal power dynamics. In the years after 9/11, Lashkar did not fragment and nor did it birth any major splinters of note, like Jaish's Jamaat ul-Furqan. The fact that Lashkar was allowed to be more active in Indian-administered Kashmir than other groups helped. So too did its Ahl-e-Hadith identity, which meant many of its members did not share the same connections to other groups and therefore were less portable. In addition, several Lashkar members told the author that militants who were no longer participating in the Kashmir jihad for any number of reasons could 'go into the reserves.' Some of them might assume support roles for Lashkar's militant activities, but others maintained their connection to the organization via above-ground social work or preaching done through JuD.[33] This enabled the group to keep these men under its control. Lashkar's ideological focus on dawa and jihad contributed to this dynamic since it allowed some militants to maintain a sense of mission even when not fighting.

However, while Lashkar's organizational cohesion was strong relative to other outfits, it was not absolute. The group inevitably 'threw off' some small splinters to quote one member of the security services.[34] Individuals also took leave, or in some cases quit the organization, to work with other outfits or fight alongside the Taliban. This process accelerated after the leadership reaffirmed its willingness to submit to state control in 2003 and slowed its activities in the Kashmir jihad following the 2004 peace accord. Some of those who left maintained links with the organization and sometimes returned to the Lashkar-fold. Others remained part of Lashkar and engaged in occasional freelance activities or agitated for policy changes from within the organization. Three notable trends developed as a result. First, from an analytical perspective it is not always clear who was in and who was out, thereby making it difficult to assess sanctioned from unsanctioned activities at times. Second, the number of connections to the other networks and outfits that were less amenable to the state's agenda increased, since Lashkar members did not necessarily break all ties with the group to work with these other entities. Third, some of those with a broader